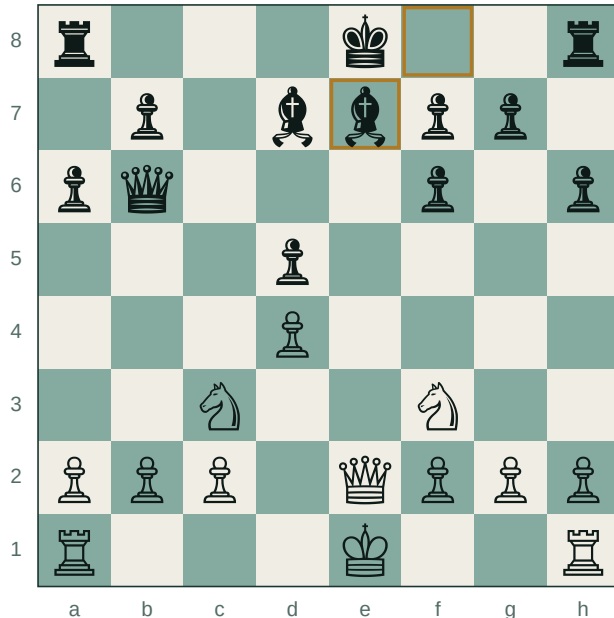


Attraction tactics: White, move 12

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 11...Be7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. Qxe7+ Kxe7 13. Nxd5+ Kd6 14. Nxb6

12.Qxe7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e7 it attacks king on e8 and bishop on d7. Recorded reply: **12...Kxe7**.

13.Nxd5+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on e7 and queen on b6. Recorded reply: **13...Kd6**.

14.Nxb6 The knight captures the queen on b6. From b6 it attacks rook on a8 and bishop on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: bishop on e7.